



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Anthem Classical Academy
School Website: <https://anthemclassical.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Classicality Audit: Bishop Louis Reicher Catholic School (Waco, TX)

Website used: <https://bishopreicher.com>

Executive Summary

Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Why: Public materials clearly and repeatedly foreground Catholic formation (four-year theology sequence; sacred scripture; sacramental life; regular participation in sacred liturgy and music; catechesis; Education in Virtue), which strongly fulfills the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations of a classical school. However, stated aims and program highlights lean toward modern college-prep and STEM/experiential emphases (PSAT/National Merit positioning; AP Calculus; "hands-on learning," robotics, coding, competitions), with little explicit evidence of trivium/quadrivium framing, Socratic seminar, scholé/restful learning, memorization/recitation, or parent formation. On balance, this yields strong theological/liturgical grounding with partial classical curriculum signals (classic literature; classical languages) but modern pedagogical posture and purpose statements.

Framework and lexicon: Analysis follows the Six Essential Elements keyword framework (positive/negative indicators) and the companion lexicon for classical signals (truth, goodness, beauty; theology; liturgy; trivium/quadrivium; Great Books; Socratic; scholé; wonder; chanting; project-based; experiential learning; college and career ready; STEM, etc.).

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS

Definition anchors: transcendental moral realism; grounded in theology; liturgical and communal practices. Positive indicators include theology, sacred scripture, sacramental life, liturgy, catechesis, virtue; negatives include values-neutrality, relativism, religiously neutral framing.

1) Keywords/phrases found on the school site

- "four-year theology program," "sacred scripture," "moral and sacramental life," "nature of the Church" (High School Program)
- "Rooted in gospel principles," "growth in ... character, and faith" (High School Program)
- "Word of Life catechesis," "Dominican Sisters' Education in Virtue," "regular participation in sacred liturgy and music" (Lower School overview)

2) Comparison to Six Elements lexicon

- Positive matches: theology, sacred scripture, sacramental life, Church, liturgy, sacred music, catechesis, virtue, character, faith (all strong positive signals).
- Negative matches: none observed (no values-neutral or relativist language).

3) Positive vs. negative count and coverage estimate

- Positive hits: 11 (theology, sacred scripture, sacramental life, Church, gospel, liturgy, sacred music, catechesis, virtue, character, faith)
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Percent coverage (of the three sub-themes): ≈ 0.67 – 0.75 (explicit on theology and liturgy; transcendental moral realism/“truth, goodness, beauty” not explicitly named)

4) Category score: CLASSICAL

- Justification: Robust, explicit theological integration and routine liturgical practice match the strongest positive indicators.
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CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL

Definition anchors: cultivation of wisdom and virtue; formation not mere information; pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty. Negatives include college-and-career-readiness framing, measurable-outcomes emphasis.

1) Keywords/phrases found

- Positive: “growth in ... character, and faith,” “Education in Virtue,” catechesis (formation language)
- Negative: “college-prep,” “PSAT,” “National Merit recognition,” “AP Calculus,” “prepare ... to excel in college” (outcomes/job-track language)

2) Comparison to lexicon

- Positive matches: formation, virtue, faith (formation orientation).
- Negative matches: college-prep, PSAT/National Merit, AP (signals of measurable outcomes/college-and-career readiness).

3) Counts and coverage

- Positive hits: 3–4
- Negative hits: 5–7
- Percent positive: ≈ 0.35 – 0.45
- Percent coverage: ≈ 0.40 (formation noted; no explicit “truth, goodness, beauty” language; emphasis on college outcomes dilutes telos-of-virtue emphasis)

4) Category score: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Justification: Mixed aims—clear formation language but prominently framed as college-prep with testing/AP positioning.
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CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM

Definition anchors: liberal arts (trivium/quadrivium); history (not Social Studies); Great Books/Great Conversation; cultivation of wonder. Negatives include STEM-first branding, project-based dominance, “social studies” in place of history.

1) Keywords/phrases found

- Positive: “modern and classical languages”; “Classic literature... Dickens, Shakespeare, Homer, Sophocles, Jane Austen, Fitzgerald” (Great Books/authors); “four-year theology” (interdisciplinary theological integration)

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- Negative: “Social Studies” (division list); Robotics emphasis; “hands-on exploration”; AP calculus/P-SAT (progressive/modern signals)
- 2) Comparison to lexicon
- Positive matches: classical languages; Great Books/authors; theological study as integrating center.
 - Negative matches: social studies terminology; STEM/experiential framing.
- 3) Counts and coverage
- Positive hits: 4–5 (classical languages, multiple Great Books authors, theology)
 - Negative hits: 3–4 (social studies; STEM/experiential signals)
 - Percent positive: ≈ 0.55 – 0.60
 - Percent coverage: ≈ 0.40 (Great Books present; trivium/quadrivium and wonder not explicit; history label diluted by “Social Studies”)
- 4) Category score: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Justification: Genuine Great Books emphasis and classical languages alongside contemporary STEM/experiential framing and social-studies labeling.
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CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY OR TEACHING METHODS

Definition anchors: scholé/restful learning; singing/chanting/recitation in lower grades; Socratic seminars/debate in upper grades; rhetoric in practice. Negatives include project-based/experiential-only emphasis.

- 1) Keywords/phrases found
- Positive: none explicit (no Socratic, scholé, chanting/recitation evidence in public pages)
 - Negative: “hands-on learning,” “problem-solving, coding, engineering challenges,” “projects and competitions,” “critical thinking, data analysis” (experiential/project-based signals)
- 2) Comparison to lexicon
- Positive matches: none observed (no Socratic/seminar/restful learning/memory work mentioned)
 - Negative matches: experiential learning; project-based education.
- 3) Counts and coverage
- Positive hits: 0
 - Negative hits: 4–5
 - Percent positive: 0.00
 - Percent coverage: ≈ 0.10 (no explicit evidence for lower/upper classical methods)
- 4) Category score: NOT CLASSICAL
- Justification: Public pedagogy language skews experiential/STEM/project-based; no stated Socratic/scholé/recitation methods.
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CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY

Definition anchors: teachers as models of virtue; mentors; collegial “faculty of friends”; portrait/profile of a teacher/student.

- 1) Keywords/phrases found
- Visible leadership/board/Head of School contact; no explicit teacher-as-mentor/virtue modeling language in public crawl snippets.

2) Comparison to lexicon

- Positive matches: none explicit on public pages (no “mentors,” “models of virtue,” “faculty collegium”)
- Negative matches: none specific (absence of evidence)

3) Counts and coverage

- Positive hits: 0
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 0.00
- Percent coverage: 0.10 (insufficient evidence in crawl to confirm faculty formation or profile)

4) Category score: NOT CLASSICAL

- Justification: Lack of public statements describing faculty as the “living curriculum,” mentors/models of virtue, or portrait of a teacher.
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CATEGORY 6: SCHOOL PARENTS AND COMMUNITY

Definition anchors: partnership with parents/co-teachers; parent education/book studies; open/hospitable community. Negatives: consumer framing, minimal parent involvement.

1) Keywords/phrases found

- None explicit in crawl snippets regarding parent partnership, parent formation, or open visitation policies.

2) Comparison to lexicon

- Positive matches: none found in provided pages.
- Negative matches: none specific (absence of evidence).

3) Counts and coverage

- Positive hits: 0
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 0.00
- Percent coverage: 0.00

4) Category score: NOT CLASSICAL

- Justification: No discoverable evidence of parent partnership/formation initiatives in the surfaced crawl.
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Aggregate Rating

- Religious & Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL
- Purpose & Goal: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Curriculum: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Pedagogy: NOT CLASSICAL
- Faculty: NOT CLASSICAL
- Parents & Community: NOT CLASSICAL

Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Rationale: The school’s theological/liturgical life and virtue formation are strong classical signals. However, aims and methods—framed around college-prep metrics and experiential/STEM programming—lack the distinctive classical pedagogy (Socratic, scholé, memory/recitation) and comprehensive liberal-arts articulation (trivium/quadrivium, wonder) expected by the Six Elements framework.

What would move the needle

- Name the telos explicitly: Feature the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty as transcendent, real, and knowable; foreground wisdom/virtue as the goal over college outcomes.
- Publish the classical architecture: Articulate trivium/quadrivium across K–12; rename “Social Studies” to “History”; add a visible Great Books/primary-sources list by grade and “Great Conversation” language.
- Pedagogy shift in public: Highlight Socratic seminars (upper school), progymnasmata/rhetoric performances, chanting/recitation and songs (lower school), and scholé/restful learning practices; document showcases (debates, orations, theses).
- Faculty formation: Publish a “Portrait of a Teacher” and faculty formation in classical pedagogy; present teachers as mentors/models of virtue—the “living curriculum.”
- Parent partnership: Introduce parent formation (book clubs, seminars on classical education), and communicate parent-school partnership as co-educators.

Evidence Appendix (select)

- High School Program: theology; sacred scripture; sacramental life; Church; classic literature authors; college-prep/AP/PSAT framing.
- Lower School Overview: catechesis; Education in Virtue; sacred liturgy and music; Singapore Math; “Social Studies”; hands-on/data analysis language.
- Robotics: hands-on learning; coding/engineering; projects/competitions (experiential/STEM).
- Keyword framework and lexicon used for scoring.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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